

Tom Harris

t.m.harris@lse.ac.uk | [GitHub](#) | [Website](#)

LSE Department of Economics, 32 Lincoln's Inn Fields, London

Education

London School of Economics

Expected 2030

PhD Economics

Primary fields: Public Economics; Environmental Economics; Development Economics

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2022

MASc Data, Economics and Development Policy, 5.0 GPA

University of Cambridge

2020

MPhil Development Studies

University of Warwick

BSc Philosophy, Politics and Economics (Economics Major), First Class Honours

2019

Experience

London School of Economics

Sept 2025 –

PhD Student, LSE

Harvard University

Graduate Student Affiliate, Opportunity Insights

Jul 2025 –

Predocutorial Fellowship under Prof. Raj Chetty, Opportunity Insights

Jul 2023 – Jul 2025

Graduate Research Assistant to Prof. Raj Chetty, Opportunity Insights

Jan – Aug 2022

The World Bank Group

May – Aug 2022, Jan – Jun 2023

Consultant, Development Impact Evaluation Unit

UK Civil Service

Oct 2020 – Jan 2022, Jan – Jul 2023

Fast Stream Economist, Government Economic Service

Barclays Investment Bank

2019, 2020

Summer Analyst, Portfolio Management, Equity Research

Affiliations

Opportunity Insights, Graduate Student Affiliate

Jul. 2025 –

Meta, Research Affiliate, Central Applied Science

Jul. 2025 –

UK Office for National Statistics, Accredited Researcher

Sept. 2025 –

Research

Working Papers

“The Shape of Economics: Semantic Structure, Knowledge Flows and Specialization” (2026) ([SSRN](#))

“Social Capital in the United Kingdom: Evidence from Six Billion Friendships” with Thomas Rutter, Shankar Iyer et al. (2025)

“Social Networks and Wellbeing” with Thomas Rutter, Shankar Iyer et al. (2025)

Policy Papers

“Levelling Up the United Kingdom”, UK Government White Paper (2022)

Presentations

2025 Opportunity Insights (Summer of Opportunity Conference); Network Science in Economics Conference (Stanford)*; UCL; University of Cambridge*; Behavioural Insights Team

2021 UK Government Social Research Conference

* presented by co-author

Teaching

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

14.33, Economic Research & Communication

Spring 2022

14.750x: Political Economy and Economic Development

Spring 2023, 2024

14.73x: The Challenges of Global Poverty

Spring 2024

14.009x: Good Economics for Hard Times

Fall 2025

14.444x: Energy Economics and Policy

Spring 2026

Skills

Software skills

R, Python, Stata, SQL, LaTeX, GitHub, Microsoft Office

Awards and Scholarships

Richard Karl Goeltz Scholarship, London School of Economics

2025

Global Priorities Institute Fellowship, Oxford University

2022

UK Government Economic Service Full Scholarship to study at MIT

2022

Academic Commendation, Warwick University

2017